

HS 522: Research Methodology for Humanities and Social Sciences

Course Code	HS 522
Course Name	Research Methodology for Humanities and Social Sciences
L-T-P-C	4-0-0-4
Intended for	Ph.D.; M.A. Development Studies
Distribution	Elective (Ph.D.); Discipline Core, Semester I (M.A. Development Studies)
Approval	6th Senate (May 2014)
Revised	50th BoA (Jul 2023) and 42nd Senate (Jan 2024) - credits changed to 4-0-0-4

Preamble

This course will introduce the student to the philosophical foundations of social sciences as well as the main methods of research employed by scholars in the humanities and social sciences. The course will equip students with a practical knowledge of the different components of the research process in humanities and social sciences from a range of perspectives/approaches.

Course Contents

- **Module 1: Philosophical Foundations of Social Science:** (16 Lectures)
 - a. Positivism, Behavioral Sciences and later developments in Social Science Thought (Sociological Thinkers and Psychologists)
 - b. Idea of Social Sciences (Peter Winch/Charles Taylor)
 - c. Idea of Human Sciences (Wilhelm Dilthey)
 - d. Idea of Social Construction of Reality (Ian Hacking)
 - e. Postcolonial Theory (Gayatri Spivak, Dipesh Chakrabarty, and Homi Bhabha)
- **Module 2: Approaches to Social Science Research:** (12 Lectures)
 - a. Content analysis
 - b. Survey and field research
 - c. Quantitative and qualitative analysis
 - d. Case studies
 - e. Ethical considerations in research
- **Module 3: Designing Research:** (14 Lectures)
 - a. Formulating appropriate research questions
 - b. Hypothesis construction
 - c. The literature review
 - i. Use of the literature
 - ii. Steps in conducting a literature review
 - iii. Citations, formatting and style
 - d. The use of theory
 - e. Approaches to Data Analysis
 - i. Induction
 - ii. Deduction
 - iii. Verification
 - iv. Falsification
 - v. Empiricism and Social Research
 - vi. Analytical dilemmas

References

1. Peter Winch, *The Idea of a Social Science and Its Relation to Philosophy* (Routledge Classics), Routledge, 2007.
2. Wilhelm Dilthey, Rudolf A. Makkreel, and Frithjof Rodi, *Selected Works Volume I: Introduction to the Human Sciences*, Princeton University Press, 1991.
3. Ian Hacking, *The Social Construction of What?*, Harvard University Press, 2000.
4. Dipesh Chakrabarty, *Provincializing Europe: Postcolonial Thought and Historical Difference*, Princeton University Press, 2007.
5. Wayne C. Booth et al., *The Craft of Research*, 3rd Edition, University Of Chicago Press, 2008.
6. J. W. Creswell, *Research Design: Qualitative, Quantitative and Mixed Methods Approaches*, 4th Edition, SAGE Publications, 2013.
7. Jacques Barzun, Henry F. Graff, *The Modern Researcher*, 6th Edition, Cengage Learning, 2003.
8. William Strunk, E. B. White, and Roger Angell, *Elements of Style*, Longman, 1999.
9. David Henderson, *Interpretation and Explanation in the Human Sciences*, SUNY Press, 1993.
10. Edward Corbett and Robert Connors, *Classical Rhetoric for the Modern Student*, 4th Edition, Oxford University Press, 1998.
11. Diana Hacker, *Rules for Writers*, 7th Edition, Bedford/St. Martin's, 2011.